

Modernising identity and access security at London Luton Airport

How a structured discovery-to-configuration programme brought multi-factor authentication, privileged access management and single sign-on to an airport's enterprise environment.

My role	Client	Scope	Lifecycle
PMO Manager	London Luton Airport	MFA, PAM and SSO	Discovery to configuration

Overview

As PMO Manager, I led the governance and delivery of the Cyber Security Transformation Programme at London Luton Airport. It covered Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Privileged Access Management (PAM), Single Sign-On (SSO) and associated cyber-security enhancements.

The programme strengthened identity protection, access control and compliance across the airport's enterprise environment. It followed a structured Discovery, Assessment, Design and Configuration lifecycle.

Discovery and assessment

The programme began with a comprehensive discovery phase to evaluate existing identity and access-management practices across operational and corporate systems.

Key activities

- Audited current authentication and access-control mechanisms.
- Identified privileged accounts and legacy access dependencies.
- Assessed risk for critical systems and user roles.
- Carried out a gap analysis against NCSC and ISO 27001 standards.
- Held stakeholder workshops with IT, operations and security teams.

This gave a clear baseline for designing a secure, scalable identity-management architecture.

Design

The design phase defined the target architecture and integration model for the MFA, PAM and SSO solutions.

Deliverables

- An MFA architecture using Azure AD and conditional-access policies.
- A PAM design with secure vaulting, session recording and least-privilege principles.
- An SSO framework for seamless authentication across enterprise applications.
- An integration blueprint for legacy systems and airport-specific operational platforms.
- Security policy aligned with GDPR and aviation-sector compliance standards.

The design ensured interoperability between cloud and on-premises systems while keeping strong governance controls in place.

Configuration and implementation

Once the design was approved, the configuration phase delivered the technical deployment and operational readiness.

Key activities

- Rolled out MFA across corporate and operational user groups.
- Configured PAM for privileged account management and audit logging.
- Integrated SSO with critical business applications and airport systems.
- Hardened the identity infrastructure and access gateways.
- Ran user-acceptance testing and a phased go-live across departments.

The implementation achieved full coverage across the airport's IT estate, improving resilience and user experience.

Governance and assurance

I established PMO governance to keep delivery disciplined, compliant and aligned with stakeholders throughout the programme.

Responsibilities

- Programme planning and milestone tracking.
- Risk and issue management across technical streams.
- Vendor coordination and assurance reviews.
- Reporting to senior airport leadership and the cyber-security steering group.
- Continuous improvement of delivery processes and documentation.

This framework gave the programme transparency, accountability and consistent delivery quality.

Outcomes and impact

- A stronger identity and access-management posture.
- Better protection of privileged accounts and critical systems.
- Streamlined authentication through SSO and MFA adoption.
- Improved compliance with aviation and data-protection standards.
- A foundation for future Zero-Trust architecture initiatives.

Strategic contribution

The programme delivered a secure, integrated and compliant identity-management ecosystem for London Luton Airport.

By combining MFA, PAM and SSO under a unified cyber-security framework, the airport gained a resilient foundation for operational continuity and digital transformation.